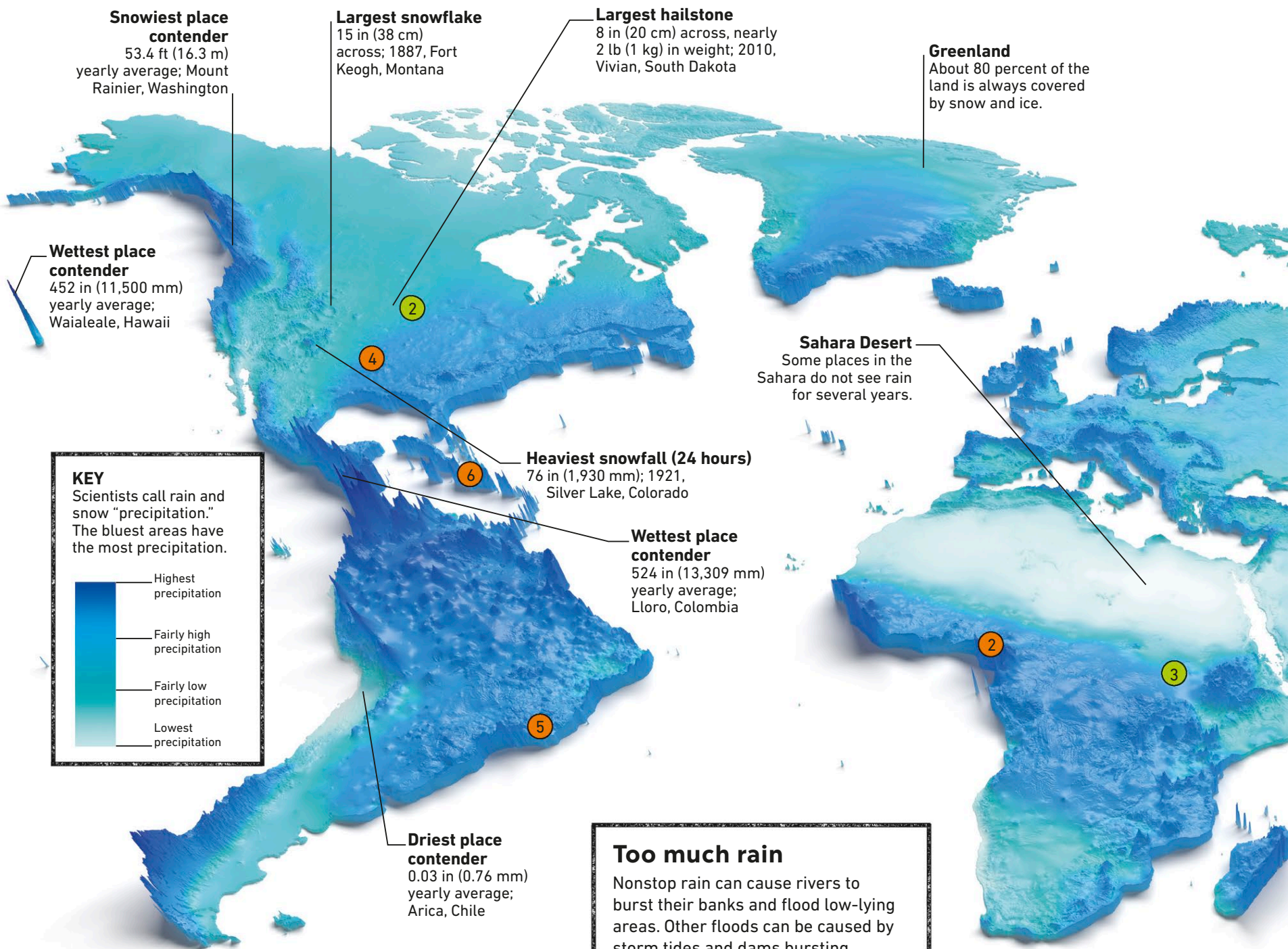




Flash floods

If a lot of rain falls in a short time it can result in "flash" floods, when torrents of water suddenly run off hills into valleys.

- Tehran, Iran, 1954**
A flash flood rushed through a gully killing about 2,000 people who had gathered for religious devotions.
- Black Hills, South Dakota, 1972**
There were 238 deaths in a matter of hours; total damage was \$165 million.
- Darfur and South Sudan, 2007**
Flash floods left 750,000 homeless.
- Krasnodarskiy Kray, Russia, 2012**
150 were killed in the worst flooding and landslides in 70 years.

Too much rain

Nonstop rain can cause rivers to burst their banks and flood low-lying areas. Other floods can be caused by storm tides and dams bursting.

- Yangtze River, China, 1931**
Caused by the Yangtze bursting its banks. Killed 3.7 million people directly as well as from disease and starvation. China's Yellow River also flooded disastrously.
- African floods, 2007**
Some of the worst, most widespread flooding in history, affecting a belt of countries from Senegal eastward to Ethiopia and as far south as Rwanda.
- Bangladesh, 1998**
Two-thirds of the country was covered with water, and 25–30 million people lost their homes. Many floods affect this low-lying country, which is mostly floodplain.
- Mississippi Flood, US, 1927**
The most destructive river flood in the history of the United States, with 246 deaths reported.
- Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, 2011**
In 24 hours, the local weather service recorded more rainfall than was expected for the entire month; caused mudslides and 903 deaths.
- Haiti and the Dominican Republic, 2004**
Torrential rains made the Solie River overflow, causing floods and mudslides that destroyed villages and killed more than 2,000 people.